

■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Wednesday, August 12, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (3 stories)

■ **EU forces AI companies to label machine-written content**

***The Angle:** Europe's new AI rules are forcing companies like Anthropic to disclose when content is AI-generated—a first real regulatory push to make the technology transparent. This could reshape how the rest of the world handles AI disclosure.*

- The **EU** has introduced rules requiring AI companies to disclose **AI-generated content**
- **Anthropic**, a major player in generative AI, is among the companies affected by the new transparency mandate
- The rules apply to content generated worldwide, not just within Europe—setting a potential global standard

The Transparency Test

- If AI writes your email or your news article, should you be forced to say so—and would you actually tell people?
- Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.euronews.com/next/2026/08/11/eu-compliance-delivered-globally-anthropic-to-watermark-claudes-output-worldwide>

■ **Google's AI chatbot Gemini hits a billion users in record time**

***The Angle:** Google just announced that Gemini reached 1 billion users faster than any product in the company's history—including Search, Gmail, and Chrome. It's a massive flex on the AI adoption race and a sign that people are genuinely embracing AI tools, not just experimenting with them.*

- **Google's Gemini** has reached **1 billion users** faster than any other Google product in history
- The previous speed records were set by products like **Gmail** and **Chrome**, which took significantly longer to hit that milestone
- This milestone reflects the explosive growth of the AI chatbot market and consumer appetite for generative AI tools

The Adoption Race

- Have you actually switched to using Gemini, or are you still team ChatGPT—and does Google reaching a billion users change that for you?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://arstechnica.com/ai/2026/08/google-says-gemini-has-reached-1b-users-faster-than-any-other-google-product/>

■ **CUSMA collapse could cost Canada hundreds of thousands of jobs**

***The Angle:** A new report warns that a breakdown in Canada's trade deal with the U.S. and Mexico could trigger massive job losses and trillions in economic damage. As trade tensions simmer, this is sparking serious conversation about what happens if the continent's biggest trade agreement falls apart.*

- A report projects **hundreds of thousands of jobs** could be lost if **CUSMA** (Canada-U.S.-Mexico Agreement) breaks down
- The economic damage could reach **trillions of dollars**, according to the analysis
- The deal replaced **NAFTA** and governs trade across North America

The Stakes Check

- How many of you actually know what CUSMA is and why it matters to your paycheck—and should Canada be bracing for a trade war?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/trade-renegotiation-impact-report-9.7303374>

TRENDING TODAY

■ **Taylor Swift Makes Nashville Songwriters Hall of Fame History**

The Angle: Taylor Swift just became the youngest person ever inducted into the Nashville Songwriters Hall of Fame at 36—a major nod to her songwriting chops that goes beyond stadium tours and Grammys. This is about the craft, not just the celebrity, and it's sparking a bigger conversation about who gets recognized for what in country music and pop.

- Taylor Swift was named to the **Nashville Songwriters Hall of Fame class of 2026**, becoming its **youngest inductee ever** at age 36.
- Swift was one of **five writers** selected for induction this year.
- The induction ceremony is set for **fall 2026**.

The Debate Starter

- Is Taylor Swift's songwriter legacy defined more by her pop hits or her country roots—and does it matter for this honor?

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://variety.com/2026/music/news/taylor-swift-inductee-nashville-songwriters-hall-of-fame-1236832080/>

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ **Your DNA doesn't tell the whole story about your proteins**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Protein sequences not determined solely by DNA upends a fundamental biological assumption—has the kind of paradigm-shift potential that science communicators will want to unpack for broader audiences.

The Angle: Northeastern researchers just discovered something wild: thousands of proteins in your body exist and work perfectly fine even though your DNA doesn't have the instructions for them. It's flipping what we thought we knew about how genetics actually works.

- Study analyzed **more than 1,000 human samples** and found **thousands of stable, abundant proteins** whose sequences aren't predicted by genetic code
- The finding challenges the central dogma: DNA → RNA → Protein — turns out the last step is way more complicated than scientists thought
- These mystery proteins are **stable and abundant**, meaning they're not rare glitches — they're real, functional parts of your biology that genetics textbooks don't explain

The Mind-Bender

- If your DNA isn't writing the complete instruction manual for your proteins, what is — and what else don't we understand about how our bodies actually work?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://news.northeastern.edu/2026/08/10/protein-sequence-determination-research/>

Backup options:

■■ **Judge says Meta must pay for mental health damage it caused**

The Angle: A groundbreaking ruling just held a major tech company legally responsible for harming users' mental health through its platforms. This could reshape how we think about social media accountability and who pays when apps damage our wellbeing.

- A judge ruled Meta caused a 'public nuisance' by operating its platforms in ways that harmed mental health
- The company is now **required to fund mental health treatment** as a result of the ruling
- This marks a significant legal precedent against one of the world's largest tech companies

The Real Talk Trigger

- Should tech companies be legally forced to fix mental health damage their own apps cause—or is that on users to manage their own screen time?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://arstechnica.com/tech-policy/2026/08/meta-ordered-to-pay-567m-to-treat-youth-mental-health-problems-it-helped-create/>

■ Your drugstore products are hiding something—and it's not on the label

The Angle: A new study tested over 100 common cleaning and personal care products from big retailers and found most contain unlabeled chemicals with known health risks—some even contradict their own "natural" claims. This is a straight-up product-safety story that hits home because these are things in your bathroom and under your sink right now.

- Researchers tested **113 personal care and cleaning products** from Target, Amazon, Walmart, and Dollar Tree
- **85% contained unlabeled chemicals** with known or suspected health hazards
- **One in four products** contained chemicals that **contradict their package claims**, including synthetic chemicals in products labeled "**100% natural**"

The Label Lie

- How many products in your home right now are lying to you about what's actually in them—and what do you do about it?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Audit** - First 2 minutes -> Hosts each grab one household product they brought in, read the label out loud, and guess how many unlabeled chemicals might actually be hiding inside based on the study findings.

- **Step 2: The Call-Out** - Next 3-4 minutes -> Open phone lines: listeners call in with a product they trust and want to know if it made the study—or ask what brands they should actually be buying instead.

- **Step 3: The Takeaway** - Closing -> Hosts discuss what to look for on labels going forward and whether this changes their shopping habits, or if they're just accepting that everything is chemicals anyway.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.usnews.com/news/health-news/articles/2026-08-11/study-finds-undisclosed-chemicals-in-most-personal-care-products>

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■■ Teen spends entire summer 3D-printing a wheelchair for stranger

The Angle: A 13-year-old poured 300 hours into building a custom, fully-tricked-out wheelchair for a toddler he's never met—and it's the kind of feel-good story that actually restores your faith in the next generation. This is the stuff that goes viral for a reason.

- **13-year-old** spent **300 hours** over the summer 3D-printing a custom wheelchair
- Built the chair for a **21-month-old girl** he'd never met before
- Added **pink accents** (her favorite color), a **cupholder**, **tray table**, and **medical equipment storage**

The Feels Check

- What made this kid decide to spend his entire summer on a stranger's wheelchair—and should we be talking about this as the exception or the norm?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.abc4.com/news/wasatch-front/13-year-old-builds-3d-printed-wheelchair/>

Backup options:

■ **France fines telemarketers \$87K per unwanted call**

***The Angle:** While North American robocall complaints keep piling up, France just took enforcement to an extreme—slapping massive per-call penalties on unsolicited marketers. It's a 'good luck enforcing that' moment, but it shows how fed up other countries are getting with phone spam.*

- France is imposing **€80,000 (roughly \$87,000) per unsolicited call** to telemarketers
- The penalty applies to calls made **without prior explicit consent**
- Other **European nations** have similar enforcement provisions already in place

The Fantasy Rant

- If the U.S. and Canada had the same rule—\$87K per robocall—how much would your telemarketer owe by now?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://fortune.com/2026/08/11/france-unsolicited-telemarketers-87000-fine-per-call/>

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■■ **Cheaters now hiring PIs to spy on their spouses first**

***The Angle:** A wild reversal of the classic affair playbook: men are apparently hiring private investigators to dig up dirt on their wives before stepping out themselves. It's the ultimate paranoia meet preemptive strike—and it says something pretty dark about trust in relationships.*

- The story comes from r/nottheonion, suggesting it's anecdotal or unverified rather than a formal study or confirmed trend
- The premise: men are reportedly hiring private investigators to surveil their own wives proactively
- The apparent logic: gathering ammunition or justification before infidelity occurs

The Relationship Red Flag

- If your partner hired a PI to follow you, would that be the moment you know it's already over?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.tokyoreporter.com/japan-news/tabloid/private-eyes-report-surge-in-mens-mistresses-investigating-their-wives/>

■ **Half-billion dollar factory built zero artillery shells**

***The Angle:** A U.S. taxpayer-funded artillery plant cost over half a billion dollars but never actually produced a single shell—a stunning example of government waste that's sparking outrage about defense spending oversight.*

- A taxpayer-funded artillery manufacturing plant cost **\$533 million** to build and operate
- The facility **produced zero artillery shells** despite its intended purpose
- The project highlights major gaps in **government accountability and defense spending oversight**

The Jaw-Dropper

- How does a factory that makes nothing for over half a billion dollars even happen—and who's actually responsible?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.propublica.org/article/general-dynamics-artillery-factory-failed>

■ ICE wants to drop twenty mil on electric shock gloves

***The Angle:** Immigration and Customs Enforcement is planning a serious budget allocation for a pretty sci-fi piece of equipment—electric shock gloves—which has people online doing a double-take on whether this is real or parody news.*

- ICE plans to allocate **\$20 million** toward **electric shock gloves**
- Story surfaced on **r/nottheonion**, a subreddit dedicated to real news that sounds too absurd to be true

The Wait, What?

- Is this actually happening, or did someone's sci-fi pitch accidentally become a government budget line item?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.primetimer.com/news/is-this-actually-legal-netizens-in-disbelief-as-ice-plans-to-spend-20-million-on-electric-shock-gloves>

■ ICE wants to arm officers with electric shock gloves

***The Angle:** Immigration and Customs Enforcement is planning to equip field officers with stun gloves that deliver painful electric shocks—raising immediate questions about escalation, liability, and whether this is the right tool for immigration enforcement. It's already sparking the kind of debate that doesn't have easy answers.*

- ICE is planning to issue officers **gloves that deliver electric shocks** for field operations
- The story comes from **AP reporting** on the equipment procurement plan
- The move has landed in the **'not the onion' space**—it reads absurd but it's real

The Take-Home Question

- Is this a reasonable self-defense tool for officers in tense situations, or a line we shouldn't cross?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://apnews.com/article/ice-electric-shock-gloves-85ff746d3e0ee5f39e7a9a3f1f576252>

■ Researchers warn violent veggie cartoons might radicalise kids

***The Angle:** A new study is raising eyebrows by claiming animated violence in fruit-and-vegetable content could be a gateway to extremism in young people — a take that feels absurd on the surface, but points to a real debate about radicalization pipelines online.*

- **Researchers** have published findings claiming **violent AI-generated clips** featuring anthropomorphic fruit and vegetable characters could contribute to youth radicalization
- The study appears to focus on **content moderation gaps** in AI-generated material and how seemingly innocent or cartoonish content might normalize violence
- The claim has drawn significant **social media attention** and skepticism, particularly on Reddit's r/nottheonion community

The Absurdity Check

- Is this researchers' actual concern or a symptom of how hard it is to study online radicalization when the data gets weird?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:

<https://news.sky.com/story/violent-ai-clips-of-fruit-and-veg-characters-could-help-radicalise-young-people-researchers-claim-13571768>

■ FDA warning: One in three 'sterile' tattoo inks actually contaminated

The Angle: *Getting a tattoo just got scarier. The FDA tested commercial inks and found bacteria—including potential pathogens—in roughly a third of bottles marked sterile. That's a serious quality-control failure in an industry that's booming right now.*

- Of **118 samples labeled sterile**, **30.5% were contaminated** with bacteria
- Inks without sterility claims had **35.5% contamination rates**—barely better
- Researchers identified **94 different bacterial species**, with **one-third classified as potential pathogens**
- The FDA doesn't currently regulate tattoo inks the way it does other injectables—a major regulatory gap

The Watercooler Question

- Have you or anyone you know gotten a tattoo, and did you ever think to ask about the ink's sterility—or even know that was something you should ask about?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Host Confession Round** - First 90 seconds -> Each host quickly shares their own tattoo history (or lack thereof) and whether they've ever worried about infection or quality. Set the personal stakes.

- **Step 2: The Caller Gauntlet** - Middle segment -> Take 3–4 rapid calls: tattoo artists defending their practices, people with infection stories, or folks reconsidering their ink plans. Keep it snappy and real.

- **Step 3: The Regulatory Head-Scratch** - Close -> Host B reads aloud that the FDA **doesn't actually regulate tattoo inks like other injectables**—let Host A react. Finish with a punchy takeaway on why that's wild.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.sciencealert.com/tattoo-ink-isnt-as-sterile-as-we-thought-and-thats-a-problem>

■ Your Burger Habit Is Destroying the Planet Way Faster Than Your Car

The Angle: *A new study just dropped hard numbers on something a lot of people suspect but don't want to hear: beef and dairy farming are wrecking biodiversity and carbon way more than plant-based food production. It's not preachy—it's just the math, and it's sparking the inevitable food culture argument online.*

- **Beef and dairy account for 41% of biodiversity damage** from global farmland, despite being only a fraction of what we grow
- Just **12% of farmland produces half of all carbon loss**, with animal agriculture dominating that footprint
- Animal-sourced foods generate **8 times more carbon loss per calorie** than plant-based foods, and **14 times more biodiversity loss per calorie**

The Dinner Table Standoff

- Are you willing to cut back on beef and dairy if you knew the real environmental cost—or is that a line you're not crossing?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.oxfordmartin.ox.ac.uk/news/beef-and-dairy-drive-41-of-biodiversity-damage-linked-to-global-farmland>

■ Dolphins teaching their kids to hunt with shells

The Angle: *Researchers just caught dolphins doing something wild: they're using giant sea snail shells as hunting tools and—here's the kicker—actually teaching their calves how to do it. It's another reminder that these animals might be way smarter than we give them credit for.*

- **Dolphins chase prey into empty sea snail shells**, then raise the shell above water and gulp down the trapped fish
- **Mothers are observed teaching this 'shelling' strategy to their calves**, marking the first documented evidence of the behavior being passed down
- The discovery suggests **dolphins possess a learned hunting culture** that spreads through generations, similar to tool use in other marine and primate species

The Brain Flex

- If dolphins are out here inventing new hunting techniques and teaching them to the next generation, what are we even doing with all our supposed intelligence?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Host Takes** - Opening riff -> One host leads with amazement at dolphin intelligence; the other plays skeptic—'They're just lucky with shells, right?'—setting up the learning angle
- **Step 2: The Teaching Angle** - Mid-segment pivot -> Hosts dig into what it means that mothers are *teaching* this—compare to human parenting, ask whether this changes how we should think about animal consciousness
- **Step 3: Caller Prompt** - Open the lines -> Ask listeners: Have you seen animal behavior that shocked you? When have you realized an animal was way smarter than expected?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.sciencealert.com/dolphins-filmed-hunting-with-shells-and-possibly-passing-the-skill-to-their-offspring>

■ **Ultra-Processed Foods Linked to Higher Prostate Cancer Risk**

The Angle: *New research shows men who eat a lot of processed foods face a notably higher prostate cancer risk—raising the question of what's actually in the stuff we're grabbing for convenience.*

- Men with **higher ultra-processed food intake** showed **24% to 34% greater prostate cancer risk** versus those eating less
- Study controlled for **age, race, ethnicity, smoking, and poverty status** to isolate the UPF effect
- Prostate cancer is one of the most common cancers in men, making dietary patterns a public health concern

The Honest Reckoning

- How many of you know what you're actually eating in those grab-and-go meals—and would this study change what ends up in your cart?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Define Ultra-Processed** - First 90 seconds -> Hosts quiz each other on what counts as UPF: frozen dinners, packaged snacks, fast food, sugary cereals, energy drinks—build a real list listeners recognize
- **Step 2: The Honest Audit** - Next segment -> Each host admits one UPF staple they actually eat regularly, no judgment—makes it relatable and shows how easy it is to slip into the habit
- **Step 3: Caller Challenge** - Open phones -> Ask listeners: if you saw a **34% increased risk**, would you actually change your diet, or does it feel too distant to act on?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.fau.edu/newsdesk/articles/ultra-processed-foods-prostate-cancer-risk.php>

■ **Scientists just mapped what actual mental health looks like**

The Angle: *Forget the checklist of what's wrong with you—researchers have now identified 19 concrete dimensions of what mental health actually *is* when it's working right. It's a shift from 'not sick' to genuinely thriving, and it could change how we think about our own wellbeing.*

- A new **consensus study** identified **19 core dimensions** of positive mental health
- The research moves beyond traditional deficit-based models (what's broken) to define what flourishing actually looks like
- Study draws on **scientific consensus** across mental health research disciplines

The Reality Check

- How many of these 19 dimensions would you say you've actually got working right now—and which one surprises you that it made the list?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The 19 Dimensions Reveal** - Quick host rundown -> Hosts pick 3-4 of the 19 dimensions from the study and riff on which ones they see in themselves, their friends, or their lives right now—make it conversational, not clinical
- **Step 2: The Self-Check** - Personal reflection moment -> Each host names one dimension they feel they're strong in and one they want to work on—model the vulnerability to encourage callers to do the same
- **Step 3: Caller Dimension Audit** - Open phones -> Invite listeners to call in and share which of the 19 they think they're crushing and which one they'd pick to focus on this month—no judgment, just real talk

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.psypost.org/scientists-identify-19-core-dimensions-of-positive-mental-health-in-new-consensus-study/>

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ **Missouri's AI rules bill? AI wrote the whole thing.**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): AI-written legislation is a genuinely novel meta-story with immediate policy implications that bridges tech accountability concerns and legislative process—this has legs as the story develops.

The Angle: *A perfect full-circle absurdist moment: lawmakers drafting regulations to govern artificial intelligence apparently used AI to write the regulations themselves. It's the kind of ironic mishap that makes you wonder who's actually in control here.*

- **Missouri lawmakers** proposed AI rules, but **metadata revealed the documents were AI-generated**
- The proposal was meant to regulate AI use, creating an obvious contradiction
- The story broke via Reddit's r/nottheonion community, highlighting the unintentional irony

The Irony Check

- Should we trust AI regulations written by AI, or is this the universe's way of telling us we're not ready for this yet?
- Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.ksdk.com/article/news/local/author-openai-metadata-contradicts-missouri-lawmakers-denials-about-who-wrote-their-ai-pl aybook/63-7b808ba8-cce3-4a32-8c55-d22232c61435>

■ **Peer-Reviewed Study Exposes How Big Tech and Big Oil Work 'Hand-in-Glove' to Profit Off AI**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Peer-reviewed study documenting Big Tech and Big Oil collusion on AI is exactly the kind of hard investigative finding that fuels sustained coverage once major outlets pick it up.

The Angle: *Peer-Reviewed Study Exposes How Big Tech and Big Oil Work 'Hand-in-Glove' to Profit Off AI*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.commondreams.org/news/ai-and-fossil-fuels>

■ **San Mateo County businesses may need a permit for using humanoid robots**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Humanoid robot permitting at the municipal level represents the first concrete regulatory friction point in an emerging technology—signals the beginning of a larger policy conversation.

The Angle: *San Mateo County businesses may need a permit for using humanoid robots*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.nbcbayarea.com/news/local/humanoid-robot-permit-san-mateo-county/4126694/>

■ **Your Local Park Might Be Next to a Toxic Waste Site**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Public parks sitting atop Superfund sites combines environmental justice, public health, and accessible infrastructure in a way that will resonate with local news networks and state legislators.

The Angle: *A new study reveals that many US public parks sit surprisingly close to hazardous waste and Superfund sites, raising questions about whether families are unknowingly exposing their kids to chemical contamination while they're supposed to be getting fresh air.*

- **Superfund sites** are severely polluted locations contaminated by **hazardous waste, chemicals, or toxic materials** including abandoned factories, old mines, landfills, and industrial plants
- Many **US public parks sit surprisingly close** to these hazardous waste facilities
- The research highlights a gap between where we think parks are safe and where toxic chemical releases are actually happening

The Wake-Up Call

- Have you ever looked into what's near your favorite park or the one your kids play at—and would that knowledge change where you go?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.yahoo.com/news/science/articles/researchers-mapped-u-public-parks-120000236.html>

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)

- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Here's How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band's 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)
 - "Guillermo del Toro said 'Absolutely No Goddamn AI' in 'Pan's Labyrinth' 3D Re-Release: 'We're Protecting a Lineage of Art'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)
 - "Shop Oprah's 'favorites' at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from 'ultra-flattering' pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)
 - "'Star Trek: Starfleet Academy' Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
 - "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)
 - "'Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror' Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
 - "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC <https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o>" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
 - "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
 - "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
 - "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)
 - "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
 - "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
 - "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: 'Disappointed'" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
 - "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
 - "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
 - "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
 - "'Roseanne' Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
 - "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
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SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @NYPost (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @CTVNews (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 100+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 13 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-12 02:24 PM